



Violence and Fear

The Sons of the Serpent prevented those of different ethnic, racial, or religious backgrounds from moving into their neighborhoods. They set upon anyone they considered "undesirable" and left a serpent sign as a warning. No minority was safe from the Serpents.

The sign of the Serpent.



UNMASKED

When a foreign diplomat, General Chen, was almost assassinated, he blamed the Sons of the Serpent. The Avengers invaded the group's base, and captured the Supreme Serpent. He turned out to be Chen, who had hoped to portray the U.S. as a country full of racists.



Blame Game

Talk-show host Dan Dunn revived the Sons of the Serpent and attacked Monica Lynne, an Afro-American singer. The Black Panther rescued Lynne and attempted to infiltrate the Serpents' new headquarters. The racists captured him, disguised one of their members as the Panther and sent him to vandalize small businesses. Fortunately, the Avengers foiled the plot.

The Sons of the Serpent tried to spread their hatred across the nation, but most Americans were disgusted by them.



SNAKE DRIVE

Hoping to appeal to the ignorant and angry, the Serpents launched a big recruiting drive. In disguise, Hawkeye seized the chance to infiltrate the group.



FAKE CAPTAIN

A Serpent member once impersonated Captain America—until the real Cap exposed the imposter.

SONS of the SERPENT

THEY LIVE TO HATE. The Sons of the Serpent is an organization of costumed fanatics who despise anyone who doesn't fit their strict definition of the perfect American. They consider themselves patriots and believe that foreigners and other minority groups are hurting the country.

During the period when Dr. Hank Pym, in his role as Goliath, was stuck at 10 ft (3 meters) high, he began working with a black biochemist named Bill Foster. The Sons of the Serpent targeted Foster and attacked him. Furious, Goliath convinced the Avengers to investigate the bigots.



DISCS AND SHIELDS

Shostakov wore a disc on his belt that could be hurled as a weapon. A magnetic device inside his belt ensured the disc came back to him. The current Red Guardian employs a shield that is approximately 30 in (76 cm) in diameter and is composed of a nearly indestructible metal alloy.

RED GUARDIAN

THE RED GUARDIAN was Russia's answer to Captain America during World War II. He was a skilled athlete, trained in all forms of hand-to-combat and he briefly met the All-Winners Squad shortly after the war. When he was killed in action, a new Guardian replaced him.



Super Agent

Shostakov was a highly acclaimed test pilot for the former Soviet Union. When the KGB recruited him to be a costumed super-agent, they informed his wife that he had died during a test flight.

POWER PLAY

General Brashov looked on as his prize agent, the Red Guardian, passed a fighting test with flying colors.



WIDOW'S WARRIOR

The second Red Guardian was Alexei Shostakov, the former husband of the Black Widow.

LIVING LASER

ARTHUR PARKS dreamed of creating the ultimate handheld weapon. He designed a laser that could be projected from a device attached to his wrists. When his girlfriend broke up with him, Arthur robbed a bank to prove his power. The Avengers arrived and Arthur fell for the Wasp. He trapped the other Avengers in a ring of lasers and kidnapped her.

THE LIGHT THAT FAILED

The Avengers tracked him down in South America and rescued the Wasp. Parks decided he needed more power and implanted laser devices into his body. The devices malfunctioned and he was transformed into a being of pure energy.



IMAGE IS EVERYTHING
No longer possessing a physical body, Parks can still appear as a holographic image.

Parks becomes "solid" by increasing his density.

Pure Energy

Parks is a bodiless quantity of photons, or particles of light. He can travel at the speed of light, communicate telepathically and project laser blasts.

